Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Middle Africa

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QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Kenya & Nigeria

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Training Role(s):	GBS_GDN_PTC_CLUSTER 4
Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit
AWA	Anglophone West Africa
CC	Country code
EA	East Africa
FWCA	Francophone West and Central Africa
LO	Local Organization

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Middle Africa are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database - Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU - Supports the process for reimbursement management - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Organizes the complaint sample and sends it to the RQU if requested. - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

Bayer Middle Africa consist of three entities: Bayer East Africa Ltd (LE1427) with office in Nairobi, Kenya, Bayer Nigeria Limited (LE1918) with office in Lagos, Nigeria, and Bayer West Central Africa SA (LE1917) with office in Abidjan, Cote d'Ivoire.

Below is a detailed list of all countries in Bayer Middle Africa cluster.

	West Central Africa / CC	
East Africa / CC	**Francophone WCA / CC**	**Anglophone West Africa / CC**
Burundi / BI	Benin / BJ	Ghana / GH
Comoro Island /KM	Burkina Faso / BF	Gambia GM
Djibouti / DJ	Cameroon / CM	Liberia / LR
Eritrea / ER	Central African Rep. / CF	Nigeria / NG
Ethiopia / ET	Chad / TD	Sierra Leone / SL
Kenya / KE	Cote d' Ivoire / CI	
Rwanda / RW	Dem. Rep. of Congo (Kinshasa) / CD	
	Equatorial Guinea / GQ	
Seychelles / SC	Gabon / GA	
Somalia / SO	Guinea (Conakry) / GN	
South Sudan / SS	Mali / ML	
Tanzania / TZ	Mauritania / MR	
Uganda / UG	Niger / NE	
	Rep. of the Congo (Brazzaville) / CG	
	Senegal / CN	
	Togo / TG	
	Madagascar*	

*Madagascar not geographically in WCA but is in scope for PTC handling, to align with business and product supply model.

4.1.2 Contact list

Country Quality Unit generic address: *bma.quality@bayer.com*

CQH East Africa: Sneha Mahida, *sneha.mahida@bayer.com*
CQH Deputy East Africa: Adeniyi Akinyemi, *adeniyi.akinyemi@bayer.com*

CQH West Central Africa: Adeniyi Akinyemi, *adeniyi.akinyemi@bayer.com*
CQH Deputy West Central Africa: Sneha Mahida, *sneha.mahida@bayer.com*

PTC address: *ptc.bma@bayer.com*

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Remark: Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via immediate action in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities - Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action) - All suspected cases of quality defects (4.1.13) **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed via the following e-mail address, as applicable: *pv.sewa@bayer.com (EA and AWA) or PV.NWA@bayer.com* (FWCA), unless complaint was received from PV.	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples If the sample is declared available and needed for investigation, forward complainant details to CQU to recover the sample. CQU is responsible for sample recovery and shipment to manufacturing site. Additionally, add the sample details to Excel samples list available on shared Teams.	GBS
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** After a complaint is handed in, an immediate acknowledgement of receipt is sent out to the complainant. If there is any missing data in the initial complaint (for ex. Batch number), the acknowledgment letter will be expanded with the request for providing missing data by the complainant. The acknowledgement letter could be adjusted depending on the current complaint description. - Standard templates are available in Annex 2 (Acknowledgment letter). The acknowledgement letter is not required if a colleague from LO has already acknowledged the complaint (ex. visible in the email chain) receipt and all information is available.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Response Letter after closing:

Standard response letters are sent out without involvement of the CQU

- Standard templates are available in Annex 3 (Response letter).

In some cases when the standard response letter doesn`t cover the reporter`s queries, GBS asks the CQH/CQU for the support.

Exception:

Confirmed final risk categories high and medium

Authority responses

For confirmed counterfeit cases GBS prepares a response template using Annex 3 and sends it out to the reporter after CQH/CQU confirmation.

4.1.7 RQU Contact list

GBS

For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps.

List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint:

PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx*

CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*

4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products

N/A

4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements

Personal data (name, email address, postal address, phone number, etc.) is stored only in Persona section in complaint database, which is available only for PTC Gdansk officers and local quality colleagues.

4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation)

GBS
CQU

In cases when the CQU receives a complaint firstly by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because timeline starts when phone complaint is received by the CQU.

The written complaints will be placed either in English or French language. French is not hosted language, and the complaints must be translated by contacting Bayer Service Translation Office. If a situation occurs, that there is only a phone number given in the complaint, and any information is missing (for ex. batch number), contact CQU and ask for support in calling the complainant.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement Whether a reimbursement or replacement for a product is granted, depends on the complaint assessment outcome and if the complainant asked for reimbursement or replacement. Only if complaint has been assessed as confirmed quality defect and the complainant asked for compensation, the reimbursement or replacement can be granted through credit note or goods replaced, depending on the agreement with Customer Service. To start reimbursement process, contact O2C, providing them with information about what product and amount is to be compensated. For **East Africa Countries** contact: *customerservice.ke@bayer.com*, for **West Central Africa Countries** contact: *customerservice.ke@bayer.com and customerservice.ng@bayer.com*. **Remark** For complaints with RQU abbreviated workflow (CH risk-based approach cases and CH/PH minor damage cases) decision about reimbursement (if was requested) is determined case by case by the CQH. The CQH shares the decision with the reporter, therefore no response from GBS required.	GBS
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should by checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider. The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations. Acceptance Criteria: • No Major translation deviations • Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%. . Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major. • Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured. • Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message. In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs. In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

- Due to low number of complaints in French from Middle Africa region, mandatory spot check for translations for Francophone West and Central Africa is covered by annual translations checks for France. Additional check is not required.
- CQU and CQH should be notified about all cases logged in the complaint database, as decisions are made case by case if HA notification is required for quality defects, even if it is not confirmed.

4.1.14 Others

There are distributors which are in France, however, supplies FWCA countries.

1) Piex Societe Pharmaceutique D'Import Export, France

2) Tedis, France

Complaints received from listed distributors must be logged in the complaint database with France indicated as the event/incident country, and a note should be added in the comment field: **WCA complaint**.

If the sample is required, the PTC officer approaches Middle Africa CQU who arranges sample shipment together with the CQU France.

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 "Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS"

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1	New document	2021-10-25
2	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 “Country specific SOP template version 5.0 # Provision of a breakdown of countries in West Central Africa into the # French speaking and English speaking. # Update of the addresses of the contact persons for Deputy for CQH-WCA and CCQH # Update in the Bayer Middle Africa CQU generic address. # Update in the PV addresses for Middle Africa # Update of the SOP reference number from SSC-PTC-SOP-ME-017 to SSC-PTC-SOP-MA-017 # Update in escalation rules # Update of the acknowledgement and the response letters # Privacy requirements updated # Contact for reimbursement requests updated # Exception and special cases chapter updated	2024-10-14
3	# Distribution sheet updated # Training role updated # Through the document, “Dev@Com” replaced by “Complaint Database” Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Section 4.1.1 Madagascar added to the WCA list of countries # Section 4.1.2 Reference to QINT SharePoint updated # Section 4.1.3 Escalation rules: escalation on initial risk category removed, escalation regarding final risk categories changed to high and medium according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0. Reference to QINT SharePoint updated. # Section 4.1.7 Updated references to global lists with RQU names for PH and CH # Section 4.1.9 Data privacy requirements rules updated # Section 4.1.11 Remark added # Section 4.1.14 information about French distributors added.	See Cover page

7 Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

Templates


Acknowledgement letter.docx


Response letter.docx

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Adeniyi Akinyemi (adeniyi.akinyemi@bayer.com) Approver - Content 08-Dec-2025 13:02:45 GMT+0000
Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Sneha Mahida (sneha.mahida@bayer.com) Approver - Content 08-Dec-2025 14:20:46 GMT+0000
Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	katarzyna mazur kominek (katarzyna.mazur-kominek@bayer.com) Approver 08-Dec-2025 14:35:20 GMT+0000